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Dominican Republic Real Estate Buyer's Guide

SOSÚA · CABARETE · THE NORTH COAST

2026 EDITION

Presented by Sheena Sesook & Michael Galea



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Welcome to the North Coast

Buying property in the Dominican Republic can be incredibly rewarding.

But buying here is different from buying in Canada, the United States or Europe.

The biggest difference isn't necessarily the paperwork.

It's knowing what questions to ask before you put your money down.

This guide was created to give buyers a practical introduction to purchasing property and living on the Dominican Republic's North Coast, particularly around Sosúa, Cabarete and Puerto Plata.

We live here, work here and understand that buying a property is about much more than finding something beautiful online.

You need to understand the title, the community, the utilities, the HOA, the rental rules, the construction, the taxes, the neighborhood and what it will actually cost to own the property once the purchase is complete.

This guide is designed to help you ask better questions and make better-informed decisions.

A Quick Note Before We Start

The information in this guide is intended for general educational purposes and is not legal, tax, immigration, accounting or financial advice.

Dominican laws, regulations, taxes, immigration requirements, financing terms, HOA rules and market conditions can change.

Figures and examples are provided as general planning information and should be independently verified at the time of your purchase.

Your Dominican attorney should review the legal aspects of your specific transaction, and a qualified tax professional should advise you on your individual tax situation.

Information in this guide is current to the best of our knowledge for 2026, but buyers should always verify current requirements before acting.



The Dominican Republic at a Glance

The Dominican Republic occupies the eastern portion of the island of Hispaniola in the Caribbean.

It offers:

- Tropical year-round weather
- Beaches and mountains
- A growing tourism economy
- International airports
- Established expatriate communities
- A wide range of real-estate prices
- Direct property ownership for foreign buyers
- A relatively straightforward process for purchasing titled real estate

The North Coast is particularly popular with international buyers because it combines established communities with beaches, restaurants, outdoor activities, international connectivity and a large existing foreign-owner population.



Why the North Coast?

The North Coast is not one single market.

Sosúa, Cabarete and Puerto Plata each have a different feel, different property types and different buyer profiles.

That matters.

A buyer looking for a vacation condo, a full-time family home, a short-term rental investment or a development opportunity may find very different opportunities in each town.

Sosúa

The lifestyle

Sosúa offers one of the North Coast's most established international communities.

You'll find:

- Beaches
- Restaurants
- Supermarkets
- Medical services
- Banks
- Gyms
- Schools
- Gated communities
- Condos
- Villas
- Long-term residents
- Short-term vacation rentals

Sosúa is particularly attractive to buyers who want to be close to everyday conveniences while still having access to the beach and a large international community.

Property

The market includes everything from smaller condos and apartments to large luxury villas and development land. Buyers will find both resale properties and newer construction.

Rental market

Sosúa has a substantial vacation-rental market, but rental performance varies considerably by location, property type, condition, management, amenities and season.

Do not purchase based solely on a generic occupancy or income projection.



Cabarete

The lifestyle

Cabarete is known internationally for its:

- Kitesurfing
- Windsurfing
- Beachfront restaurants
- Outdoor lifestyle
- International community
- Walkable beachfront areas
- Vacation-rental market

It attracts a particularly international mix of residents and visitors.

Property

Cabarete offers beachfront condos, apartments, villas, gated developments and land. Beach proximity can have a significant impact on both lifestyle and rental appeal.

Rental market

Cabarete has a strong vacation-rental market, particularly around beachfront and watersports-oriented properties. However, rental performance varies significantly between individual properties.

A beachfront condo with strong amenities and professional management should not automatically be compared with an older apartment several kilometers inland.

Puerto Plata

Puerto Plata is the larger city and regional center of the North Coast.

It offers:

- Hospitals
- Government services
- Banks
- Shopping
- Restaurants
- Schools
- Historic areas
- Beaches
- Mountain access
- The cable car
- Residential communities

Puerto Plata can appeal to buyers who want more of a traditional Dominican city environment and access to a broader range of everyday services.



Beyond the North Coast

The Dominican Republic is much larger than the North Coast.

Other areas buyers commonly consider include:

Santiago

The country's major inland metropolitan center and an important location for healthcare, business, shopping and services.

Santo Domingo

The capital and largest metropolitan area, with extensive business, medical, cultural and government services.

Las Terrenas

A popular international community on the Samaná Peninsula, known for beaches, restaurants and a strong expatriate presence.

Punta Rucía

A quieter coastal area known for beaches, boating and access to nearby natural attractions.



Getting Here

North Coast Airports

Gregorio Luperón International Airport — POP

Located between Puerto Plata and Sosúa, POP is the primary international airport for much of the North Coast.

Approximate drive times:

- Sosúa: ~10–20 minutes
- Cabarete: ~20–35 minutes
- Puerto Plata: ~20–30 minutes

Actual drive times depend on traffic and exact destination.

Cibao International Airport — STI

Located near Santiago. STI can be useful for North Coast buyers depending on flight availability and destination.

From Sosúa or Cabarete, allow approximately 60–90 minutes or more, depending on traffic and exact location.

Santo Domingo — SDQ

Useful for travelers whose flights are better served through the capital. Expect a substantially longer drive to the North Coast.

Punta Cana — PUJ

Punta Cana is on the opposite side of the country and generally isn't the practical airport for someone specifically purchasing in Sosúa or Cabarete unless their travel plans make it worthwhile.

Flight Times

Approximate nonstop flight times vary by departure airport and season. As a general planning reference:

- Miami: roughly 2.5–3 hours
- New York: roughly 4 hours
- Toronto: roughly 4 hours
- London: roughly 9 hours

Always check current airline schedules because routes are seasonal and change regularly.



Entering the Dominican Republic

Visa requirements depend on nationality.

Most travelers from the United States, Canada, the United Kingdom and the European Union do not require a visa for standard tourist entry.

Passport validity

The general Dominican requirement is six months of passport validity.

However, through December 31, 2026, there is a temporary exception for nationals of certain countries, including the United States, Canada, United Kingdom, European Union countries and several Latin American countries, allowing qualifying tourists to enter with passports valid for their stay/departure.

Because entry rules can change, check the official requirements before every trip.

New for 2026: Your E-Ticket Profile

The Dominican Republic's E-Ticket system has been updated to make repeat travel easier.

Travelers can now create a profile and save their information, rather than starting completely from scratch every time they enter or leave the country.

The updated system also supports information for families and returning/frequent travelers.

You will still need to review and update trip-specific information, including your flight and accommodation details, for each trip.

The E-Ticket is free and is required for passengers arriving in or departing from the Dominican Republic on commercial flights.

How Long Can You Stay?

Standard tourist admission is generally 30 days.

Visitors who want to remain longer can use the official stay-extension process, subject to the applicable requirements and fees.

If you expect to spend substantial portions of the year in the Dominican Republic, it is worth discussing residency with an immigration professional rather than assuming repeated tourist stays are the best long-term solution.



Tourism

Tourism is one of the Dominican Republic's major economic drivers.

In 2025, the country reported 11,676,901 visitors, including both air arrivals and cruise passengers.

That represents an important underlying driver for hospitality, vacation rentals, restaurants, transportation and real estate in tourism-focused areas.



Weather & Hurricanes

The Dominican Republic has a tropical climate, with warm temperatures throughout the year.

The Atlantic hurricane season officially runs from June 1 through November 30.

The North Coast is not immune to hurricanes or tropical storms. Storm impacts depend heavily on the storm's size, strength, track and local conditions.

When evaluating a property, buyers should consider:

- Drainage
- Elevation
- Roof construction
- Windows and shutters
- Hurricane/wind exposure
- Flood exposure
- Insurance coverage
- Backup power
- Backup water
- Road access during heavy rainfall
- Community emergency planning

Do not assume that being on the North Coast means a property is protected from storm damage.



Buying Property as a Foreigner

One of the major advantages of the Dominican Republic is that foreigners can generally purchase titled real estate directly.

Foreign individuals and entities generally have the same property ownership rights as Dominican citizens.

You generally do not need:

- Dominican residency to purchase
- A Dominican spouse
- A Dominican business partner
- A local nominee owner
- A trust simply because you are foreign

Foreign buyers can generally hold titled property directly in their own name.

That said, your ownership structure can have tax, estate-planning and liability implications, so discuss the appropriate structure with your Dominican attorney and tax advisors.



The Dominican Property-Buying Process

The process can vary depending on whether you are purchasing a resale, a new construction property, land or a development project.

A typical transaction may look like this:

- **1. Define your goals and tour properties**

Know whether you're looking for:

- Primary residence
- Vacation home
- Short-term rental
- Long-term rental
- Investment
- Land
- Development opportunity
- **2. Make an offer and negotiate terms**

Price isn't the only term that matters. Also consider:

- Payment schedule
- Closing date
- Included furniture
- Appliances
- Repairs
- Possession
- Financing
- Contingencies
- What happens if either party defaults
- **3. Hire your independent attorney**

Your attorney should represent your interests. Ideally, your lawyer should not be selected solely because the seller, developer or agent recommended them.

- **4. Conduct legal and property due diligence**

This should happen before the buyer is committed to the transaction and before meaningful funds are released without contractual protection.

- **5. Sign the Promise of Sale, if applicable**

The Promise of Sale establishes the agreed terms and obligations of the parties.

- **6. Make payments according to the contract**



Every payment should correspond to the agreed contract terms.

- **7.** Sign the final Deed of Sale

The final transfer is formalized through the appropriate legal and notarial process.

- **8.** Pay applicable taxes and register the transfer

The transfer is then registered with the appropriate Real Property Registry.



Your Attorney's Due Diligence

This is one of the most important parts of buying property in the Dominican Republic.

Your attorney should verify, as applicable:

- Certificate of Title
- Registered owner
- Cadastral identification
- Deslinde documentation where applicable
- Liens and encumbrances
- Mortgages and privileges
- Property tax status
- Transfer-tax status
- Seller's identity
- Seller's legal authority to sell
- Corporate documents if the seller is a company
- Existing legal claims or litigation
- HOA or condominium status
- Rental restrictions
- Building permits where applicable
- Environmental approvals where applicable
- Utility obligations
- Property boundaries
- Occupancy and possession
- CONFOTUR status where applicable

Before You Sign — Ask Your Attorney to Confirm

- ☐ Certificate of Title
- ☐ Cadastral/deslinde documentation
- ☐ No-debt certificate
- ☐ Tax status
- ☐ Liens and encumbrances
- ☐ Seller identity and authority to sell
- ☐ Corporate documentation, if applicable
- ☐ HOA/condo status
- ☐ Building permits, where applicable
- ☐ Environmental approvals, where applicable
- ☐ Utility status



- ☐ Property boundaries
- ☐ Occupancy/possession
- ☐ Rental restrictions
- ☐ CONFOTUR documentation, if applicable
- ☐ Mortgages or privileges
- ☐ Pending litigation affecting the property



The Promise of Sale

A Promise of Sale is commonly used to establish:

- Purchase price
- Payment schedule
- Deadlines
- Conditions
- Closing requirements
- Default provisions
- Responsibilities of each party

Deposits vary depending on the transaction.

A resale, pre-construction purchase, developer transaction and financed purchase may all have different payment structures.

Do not assume that every transaction involves a specific percentage deposit or an attorney escrow account.

Any deposit and the conditions governing its release should be clearly documented and reviewed by your attorney before you pay.



Title & Deslinde

A property listing and a registered title are not the same thing.

Ask your attorney to verify that the property you are buying corresponds with the registered ownership information and cadastral documentation.

Where applicable, confirm that the property has a completed deslinde and an appropriate individual cadastral identification.

Your attorney and, where appropriate, an independent surveyor should verify that:

- The physical property matches the documentation
- Boundaries correspond
- The seller owns what they are selling
- The registered parcel corresponds to the property being purchased

Do not assume that a “portion of rights” is the same thing as owning a separately titled parcel.

Title Registration

Once the transfer has been properly executed and registered with the relevant Title Registry, the buyer’s ownership is formally recorded.

The physical Certificate of Title may be issued or delivered later depending on the registry process.

Your attorney should track the registration process through completion.



2026 Real-Estate Regulation Update

A bill regulating real-estate intermediation and advertising has been moving through the Dominican legislative process.

The Dominican Senate approved the proposal in first reading in April 2026.

The proposed legislation includes provisions relating to licensing, registration and penalties concerning real-estate intermediation and advertising.

A first-reading approval does not mean the proposal automatically became current law.

Until legislation is finally enacted and takes effect, buyers should verify:

- ☐ The agent's identity
- ☐ Brokerage affiliation
- ☐ Professional credentials
- ☐ Who is representing them
- ☐ Who is handling their legal work



Resale vs. New Construction

Resale

Advantages can include:

- You can see exactly what you're buying
- Existing neighborhood
- Existing utilities
- Existing HOA operation
- Immediate rental potential
- Actual physical condition can be inspected

But older properties may require:

- Repairs
- Roof work
- Plumbing upgrades
- Electrical upgrades
- AC replacement
- Pool equipment
- Inverter/battery replacement
- Waterproofing
- Renovation

New Construction

Advantages can include:

- New finishes
- Modern layouts
- New infrastructure
- Developer payment plans
- Lower immediate maintenance requirements

But you're also evaluating:

- Developer
- Construction quality
- Completion timeline
- Land ownership
- Permits



- Payment structure
- Delivery obligations
- Warranty
- HOA formation
- Future fees
- Rental restrictions

Never assume that a new property is automatically lower risk.



Buying Pre-Construction?

Ask:

- Who owns the land?
- Is the land properly titled?
- Who is the developer?
- What projects have they completed?
- Is there a fideicomiso?
- What permits are approved?
- What happens if construction is delayed?
- What happens if the buyer wants to cancel?
- Is the payment schedule construction-milestone based?
- What is included in the finishing package?
- Which appliances are included?
- Which furniture is included?
- What happens if delivery is delayed?
- What warranty is provided?
- What happens if the finished unit differs from the plans?
- Is CONFOTUR actually approved or simply expected?

One important rule:

“CONFOTUR approved” and “CONFOTUR expected” are not the same thing.

Ask to see the actual approval/resolution applicable to the project.



Buyer Costs & Taxes

The final cost of purchasing a property is more than the advertised purchase price.

Potential costs can include:

- Transfer tax
- Legal/notarial fees
- Registration expenses
- Due diligence
- Surveying
- Inspections
- Appraisals
- Financing costs
- Insurance
- HOA fees
- Furnishing
- Repairs
- Utility setup

Property Transfer Tax

The Dominican Republic generally charges a 3% property transfer tax on taxable transfers.

The applicable taxable value is determined under DGII rules and should not simply be assumed to equal the property's advertised market price.

Your attorney should calculate the applicable transfer tax for your specific transaction.

Certain properties and transactions may qualify for exemptions.

Annual Property Tax — IPI

For individuals, DGII currently applies 1% to the amount exceeding RD\$10,695,494 of the individual's combined taxable real-estate patrimony for 2026.

This is based on the individual's qualifying real-estate holdings rather than simply applying the threshold separately to every property.

The threshold is adjusted periodically.

Certain exemptions can apply, including specific rules for qualifying individuals over 65 who own only one residential property, as well as other statutory exemptions.

Always verify the current DGII threshold and your personal situation.



Capital Gains — 2026 Update

Law 30-26 introduced a 10% final tax on capital gains for individuals from the sale of real estate, effective in June 2026.

DGII has confirmed that the new rate is in effect.

Certain implementation details regarding the calculation and liquidation of the tax are being developed through the applicable administrative rules.

Buyers and sellers should have their attorney or tax advisor confirm:

- The applicable taxable gain
- Cost basis
- Improvements
- Applicable exemptions
- Filing requirements
- Payment requirements

Do not rely on a generic percentage alone to calculate the tax on a future sale.

Inheritance & Estate Planning

Owning property in another country creates estate-planning considerations.

Your attorney should explain how Dominican inheritance rules interact with your personal circumstances, citizenship, family structure and ownership structure.

Do not assume that your home-country will or estate plan automatically handles Dominican property exactly as it would property in Canada, the United States or Europe.

If you own substantial Dominican assets, discuss estate planning with qualified professionals in both jurisdictions where appropriate.

CONFOTUR

CONFOTUR is a Dominican tourism incentive regime that can provide significant tax benefits to qualifying approved tourism projects.

Benefits can include exemptions from certain taxes, including property transfer and property taxes, subject to the project's approval and applicable law.

The incentive period for approved projects can extend for 15 years from completion of construction, subject to the applicable rules.

Important:

CONFOTUR is project-specific.

It is not a blanket benefit for every property in Puerto Plata, Sosúa, Cabarete or another tourism destination.

If a property is being marketed as having CONFOTUR benefits, ask to see the actual approval/resolution and have your attorney confirm that the specific unit and transaction qualify.



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Financing

Financing is available through Dominican banks, although terms can vary considerably.

Factors may include:

- Residency status
- Income
- Currency
- Credit history
- Down payment
- Property type
- Property valuation
- Employment/business documentation

Non-resident buyers may face different terms than Dominican residents.

Developer financing is also common in new construction.

Before Choosing Financing

Obtain a current term sheet and compare:

- Interest rate
- Fixed vs. variable rate
- Currency
- Down payment
- Term
- Closing costs
- Insurance requirements
- Early-payment penalties
- Qualification requirements

Do not assume rental income will automatically qualify you for a mortgage.

Currency Risk

If your income is in USD, CAD, EUR or another foreign currency while your expenses are in Dominican pesos, exchange-rate changes can affect your real cost of ownership.

The same applies to rental income.

When calculating your budget, consider:

- Purchase currency



- Mortgage currency
- Rental-income currency
- HOA payments
- Utilities
- Maintenance
- Taxes
- Insurance

Build your numbers in the currency you actually earn and spend.



Inspection & Physical Due Diligence

Legal due diligence tells you whether you can legally buy the property.

It does not tell you whether the roof leaks.

For a resale property, consider an independent inspection or qualified engineer where appropriate.

Look at:

- Roof
- Electrical system
- Plumbing
- Water pressure
- Water tanks
- Pumps
- Septic/wastewater systems
- Pool equipment
- AC units
- Inverters
- Batteries
- Generators
- Humidity
- Water intrusion
- Structural concerns
- Doors and windows
- Drainage

A beautiful property can still have expensive hidden problems.

Rain, Drainage & Flood Risk

Two properties only a few minutes apart can have very different drainage characteristics.

Before purchasing, ask:

- Has the property ever flooded?
- Has water entered the house?
- How does rainwater leave the property?
- Where does roof water drain?
- Is the property elevated?
- Are retaining walls properly constructed?



- How does the road perform during heavy rain?
- Is the community drainage system maintained?
- Is there a history of water intrusion?

This is especially important when purchasing a ground-floor property, basement-level area or property near waterways or low-lying roads.



HOA & Condo Fees

Don't look only at the monthly HOA number.

Ask what you're actually receiving for that fee.

Request:

- Current monthly HOA fee
- What's included
- Reserve fund
- Outstanding owner balances
- Pending special assessments
- Recent HOA meeting minutes
- Rental rules
- Pet restrictions
- Renovation restrictions
- Generator/inverter coverage
- Pool maintenance
- Common-area maintenance
- Insurance coverage
- Security
- Water
- Garbage
- Future planned increases

Most importantly: confirm whether short-term rentals are permitted.

Never assume that because other units are listed on Airbnb or another platform, your unit is automatically allowed to operate as a short-term rental.



Rental Property

If your goal is rental income, treat the property like a business.

Your revenue can depend on:

- Location
- Beach proximity
- Property type
- Number of bedrooms
- Pool
- View
- Amenities
- Condition
- Furnishing
- Reviews
- Management
- Seasonality
- Pricing strategy
- Rental restrictions

Rental Occupancy

There is no single reliable occupancy rate for the entire North Coast.

Current market datasets can produce materially different results depending on the properties included and the methodology used.

Some properties will perform below broad market averages. Others may significantly outperform them.

The rule: never underwrite a purchase using a generic occupancy assumption.

Instead, request actual historical booking and revenue data for the property whenever possible.

For a new property, use conservative comparable-property assumptions rather than the highest projection supplied by a salesperson.

Before You Believe a Rental Projection

Ask for:

- Previous 12–24 months of booking history
- Gross rental revenue
- Occupancy



- Average nightly rate
- Management fees
- Electricity
- HOA
- Cleaning costs
- Maintenance
- Platform fees
- Taxes
- Owner-use nights
- Periods when the property was unavailable

Remember: projected income is not the same thing as historical income.

Rental Management

Professional management can be useful for owners who live abroad.

Services can include:

- Guest communication
- Check-in/check-out
- Cleaning
- Maintenance coordination
- Linen service
- Pool care
- Utility management
- Pricing
- Listing management
- Emergency response

Management fees vary depending on the property and services provided.

Before signing a management agreement, understand:

- Commission percentage
- Cleaning charges
- Maintenance markups
- Guest communication
- Owner-use rules
- Cancellation policy
- Contract term
- Termination provisions
- Who collects the money



- When you are paid

Short-Term Rental Restrictions

Before buying a condo or gated-community property for Airbnb or vacation rentals, check:

- HOA bylaws
- Condominium regulations
- Development rules
- Minimum rental periods
- Local requirements
- Management agreements
- Registration/licensing requirements where applicable

Never rely solely on what another owner is doing.

Cost of Owning a Rental

Your gross rental revenue is not your profit.

Expenses may include:

- HOA
- Electricity
- Water
- Internet
- Cleaning
- Maintenance
- Pool
- Gardening
- Management
- Platform fees
- Insurance
- Property taxes
- Repairs
- Replacement furniture
- Appliances
- Inverter/battery maintenance
- Generator maintenance

Build your investment model using net income, not gross revenue.



Property Insurance

Obtain an actual insurance quote before closing.

Insurance costs can vary significantly depending on:

- Construction
- Location
- Hurricane/wind exposure
- Flood exposure
- Property value
- Contents
- Liability
- Pool
- Security
- Short-term rental use

Do not rely on a generic annual estimate when calculating your investment.



Healthcare

The North Coast has private clinics, medical centers and healthcare providers.

For more complex or specialist care, many North Coast residents travel to Santiago or Santo Domingo, where there is a broader selection of hospitals, specialists and advanced diagnostic services.

Buyers with specific medical needs should research:

- Nearby hospitals
- Specialists
- Emergency services
- Insurance networks
- Prescription availability
- Travel time to major medical centers

Health Insurance

Several Dominican insurers and ARS providers offer local and international/private health plans.

Coverage can vary significantly based on:

- Age
- Residency
- Coverage level
- Deductibles
- Network
- Exclusions
- Pre-existing conditions
- International coverage

Obtain current quotes before relocating.



Residency

Buying property does not automatically make you a Dominican resident.

Residency is a separate immigration process.

Common residency categories include:

Investor

The Dominican Republic has an investor-residency pathway with a qualifying investment threshold of approximately US\$200,000, subject to the specific requirements of the program.

Buying a US\$200,000 property does not automatically mean you qualify.

The investment must meet the applicable legal and documentary requirements.

Pensionado

A qualifying pension-based residency category is available.

Current DGM information provides a minimum qualifying pension of approximately US\$1,500 per month, plus an additional amount per qualifying dependent.

Rentista

A qualifying recurring foreign income route is also available.

Current DGM information provides a minimum qualifying recurring foreign income of approximately US\$2,000 per month.

Requirements and documentation apply.

Important

Residency rules can change. Speak with a qualified immigration professional before choosing a residency category.



Everyday Life on the North Coast

Buying here is only part of the decision.

You also need to understand what day-to-day life looks like.

Community

The North Coast has a large international community.

Depending on where you live, you may interact with people from:

- Dominican Republic
- Canada
- United States
- Germany
- France
- Italy
- Switzerland
- United Kingdom
- Other Caribbean and European countries

At the same time, you're living in the Dominican Republic.

Learning some Spanish can make everyday life considerably easier and more enjoyable.

Language

Spanish is the official language.

English is widely spoken in tourism and international communities, particularly around Sosúa and Cabarete.

But outside those environments, Spanish becomes increasingly important.

Even basic Spanish can make a big difference when dealing with:

- Contractors
- Utilities
- Government offices
- Mechanics
- Delivery services
- Neighbors
- Local businesses
- Medical providers



Banking

Foreigners can open Dominican bank accounts, but requirements vary by institution and by residency status.

Banks may request documentation such as:

- Passport
- Residency documents
- Proof of address
- Financial records
- References
- Tax information
- Source-of-funds documentation

Expect enhanced documentation when transferring significant sums for a property purchase.

Moving Money

When transferring money for a real-estate transaction:

- Confirm the beneficiary
- Verify bank details independently
- Confirm the currency
- Understand transfer fees
- Keep transfer records
- Confirm receipt with your attorney

Important

Do not rely solely on bank instructions sent by email or WhatsApp.

For a large property transaction, independently verify payment instructions with the intended recipient before sending funds.

Electricity

The Dominican Republic commonly uses 120V/60Hz, with 220V circuits also used in many properties.

Power interruptions can occur.

Many homes and communities use:

- Inverters
- Batteries
- Generators
- Solar systems

Ask before buying:



- Is there an inverter?
- What does it power?
- How many batteries?
- How old are the batteries?
- Is there a generator?
- What does the generator power?
- Who maintains it?
- What happens to common areas during an outage?

Water

Drinking-water quality varies by location and building infrastructure.

Many residents choose filtered, treated or bottled water for drinking, even where municipal water is suitable for bathing and household use.

Ask before buying:

- Where does the water come from?
- Is there a cistern?
- Is there a pump?
- Is there a community well?
- Is water included in HOA fees?
- How often is the system maintained?

Internet

Internet availability varies by location.

Depending on the area, buyers may have access to:

- Fiber
- Cable
- Fixed wireless
- 4G/5G
- Other local providers

If reliable internet is important to your work, verify the actual service available at the specific property rather than relying on a neighborhood-wide statement.

Household Help

Domestic help is widely available, but costs vary considerably depending on:

- Hours
- Frequency



- Responsibilities
- Experience
- Live-in vs. independent arrangement

Budget according to the actual services you expect to use rather than relying on one generalized monthly figure.

Pets

Bringing pets to the Dominican Republic is generally possible, but requirements depend on:

- Species
- Country of origin
- Vaccination status
- Veterinary documentation
- Import requirements
- Airline requirements

Confirm current veterinary/import requirements before travel.

Your airline may have additional requirements beyond Dominican entry rules.

Driving

Foreign visitors can generally drive using a valid foreign driver's licence during their permitted stay.

Longer-term residents should confirm when a Dominican driver's licence is required based on their immigration status and current regulations.

Road conditions, traffic patterns and driving styles can differ significantly from North America and Europe.

Allow extra time and exercise caution, particularly when driving at night or on unfamiliar roads.



Buying in a Gated Community

Gated communities can offer:

- Security
- Common areas
- Pools
- Landscaping
- Maintenance
- Backup systems
- Established neighborhoods

But they also come with community rules and shared expenses.

Before buying, ask for:

- HOA bylaws
- Monthly fees
- Fee history
- Reserve fund
- Special assessments
- Rental rules
- Pet rules
- Renovation rules
- Security arrangements
- Utility arrangements
- Generator/inverter coverage



The 10 Things Buyers Most Often Miss

- **1.** The property isn't the same thing as the title.

Verify what you are actually buying.

- **2.** The cheapest property isn't necessarily the cheapest property to own.

HOA fees, electricity, maintenance, insurance and repairs matter.

- **3.** A rental projection isn't a rental history.

Ask for actual numbers.

- **4.** CONFOTUR needs documentation.

Don't rely solely on a listing description.

- **5.** HOA fees can change.

Ask about previous increases and upcoming assessments.

- **6.** Not every condo permits short-term rentals.

Read the rules before buying.

- **7.** New construction has a different risk profile than resale.

Developer due diligence matters.

- **8.** A beautiful property can still have drainage, humidity or construction issues.

Inspect it.

- **9.** Your attorney works for you.

Choose independent legal representation.

- **10.** Don't send a deposit before you understand what protects it.

Have the agreement reviewed before transferring funds.



The North Coast Buyer Checklist

My Property Goals

My budget: _____

Cash / financing: _____

Primary residence / vacation home / rental / investment:

Preferred town: _____

Beach proximity: _____

Bedrooms: _____

Pool: _____

Gated community: _____

Short-term rental: _____

Long-term rental: _____

New construction / resale: _____

HOA budget: _____

Must-have: _____

Deal-breaker: _____

Before Making an Offer

- ☐ I understand the total purchase price
- ☐ I have budgeted closing costs
- ☐ I know the HOA fee
- ☐ I know what the HOA fee includes
- ☐ I know whether rentals are permitted
- ☐ I have asked about CONFOTUR if applicable
- ☐ I understand the title situation
- ☐ I have selected an independent attorney
- ☐ I have considered a physical inspection
- ☐ I have asked about drainage/flood history
- ☐ I understand the payment schedule
- ☐ I understand what furniture/appliances are included
- ☐ I have reviewed the contract before paying a deposit



Which North Coast Area Fits Your Goals?

There is no single “best” town.

It depends on what you are trying to accomplish.

Sosúa

Consider if you value:

- Established international community
- Convenient everyday services
- Variety of condos and villas
- Beach access
- Vacation and long-term rental opportunities

Cabarete

Consider if you value:

- Beachfront lifestyle
- Watersports
- International community
- Walkable beachfront areas
- Vacation-rental opportunities

Puerto Plata

Consider if you value:

- City infrastructure
- Hospitals and services
- Shopping
- Traditional Dominican city life
- Broader regional amenities



A Final Word on Buying in the Dominican Republic

The Dominican Republic can offer an incredible lifestyle and a wide range of real-estate opportunities.

But the goal shouldn't simply be to find a beautiful property.

The goal is to find a property that makes sense legally, financially, physically and personally.

Ask questions. Verify documents. Look beyond the listing photos.

Understand the ongoing costs. Understand the HOA. Understand the rental rules.

Inspect the property. Use independent legal advice.

And never let excitement about a property replace proper due diligence.



**S & M
REALTY DR**

About Sheena & Michael

Sheena Sesook & Michael Galea

S&M Realty DR
The Crest Group Dominicana

We specialize in helping buyers navigate the North Coast of the Dominican Republic, particularly Sosúa, Cabarete and Puerto Plata.

Our goal is simple:

Give buyers the information they need to make an informed decision about purchasing property in the Dominican Republic.

Whether you're looking for a home, vacation property, rental investment, land or new construction, we're here to help you understand the local market and connect you with the professionals you need throughout the process.



Important Resources & Contact

Important Resources

- Dominican Republic E-Ticket
- Dominican Republic Ministry of Tourism
- Official Dominican Republic Tourism Information — godominicanrepublic.com/travel/entry-requirements
- Dominican Republic General Directorate of Internal Taxes (DGII) — for current information regarding property taxes, transfer taxes and other tax obligations
- Dominican Republic General Directorate of Migration (DGM) — for current residency, immigration and E-Ticket requirements

Get in Touch

Sheena Sesook & Michael Galea

S&M Realty DR

Sosúa · Cabarete · Puerto Plata · North Coast, Dominican Republic

Sheena Sesook — +1 (809) 350-3736

Michael Galea — +1 (829) 637-5611

sheenaandmichaelrealtydr.com

sheena@crestgroupdominicana.com



S & M
REALTY DR



Disclaimer

This guide is provided for general informational purposes only.

It does not constitute legal, tax, immigration, accounting, financial, engineering or investment advice.

Real-estate transactions should be reviewed by an independent Dominican attorney and, where appropriate, qualified tax, immigration, engineering and financial professionals.

Laws, regulations, taxes, immigration requirements, market conditions, rental rules, interest rates and costs may change.

Always verify current information before making a purchase or financial decision.

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